CS/EE 120B Custom Laboratory Project Report

Project Title: TurretLock **Name:** Pranae Harirajan **Submission Date:** _<fill in>_

Introduction

TurretLock is a real-time targeting game. A 4-in-1 LED matrix (32x8 pixels) is the playfield: solid walls sit on the far-left and far-right four columns, and a small 2x2 "target" appears in the open space between them. The player moves a single aim dot with an analog joystick and tries to line it up with the target. When the dot is touching the target, a green LED lights to show a lock; otherwise a red LED blinks. Pressing the joystick button fires: a shot on the target scores 100 points and spawns a new target, while a shot taken off-target costs one life. A pair of servo motors act as a physical turret that swings to follow the aim.

The player starts with five lives. Targets are endless, so the score can grow without limit. When all five lives are lost, the game ends and the screen shows the final score together with the all-time high score, which is stored in EEPROM and survives power cycles. A small color TFT screen acts as a heads-up display for the score, the remaining lives (drawn as heart sprites), and the game messages (start screen, game over, and a high-score reset prompt).

Successfully completed: full core gameplay, two-axis servo turret, lock LEDs, score, five-life system with heart sprites, endless targets, EEPROM high score, start / game-over / reset screens, and a press-and-hold gesture to reset the high score. The whole program is built as Concurrent SynchSMs driven by a task scheduler.

Known limitations: the joystick is spring-loaded, so the aim is velocity-based (push to glide, release to hold) rather than absolute.

Elements of Complexity

- **EEPROM-backed high score (implemented).** The all-time high score is read from

EEPROM at power-up and written back whenever it is beaten, so it persists across power cycles. A triple-click gesture on the start/game-over screens opens a confirmation prompt to wipe it.

- **Custom bare-metal ST7735 TFT driver, no libraries (implemented).** A hand-written

driver brings up the color TFT (reset, sleep-out, gamma, 16-bit color) and draws filled rectangles, a 5x7 text font, centered text, and a heart sprite. It shares the SPI data/clock lines with the LED matrix using separate chip-select lines.

- **Custom bare-metal MAX7219 matrix driver (implemented).** A hand-written,

bit-banged driver drives the four daisy-chained 8x8 panels and periodically re-sends the configuration registers so a panel glitched by electrical noise self-heals.

- **Two-axis servo turret (implemented).** Two servos track the aim in X and Y,

driven by Timer1 in the background so motion stays smooth while the game runs.

- **Press-and-hold reset gesture (implemented).** The button's hold time is measured;

a 10-second hold opens a confirmation prompt to safely reset the high score.

User Guide

Controls

- **Joystick (X/Y):** moves the aim dot on the matrix. The stick is a speed control
- push to move the dot, release to leave it in place.
- **Joystick button - single click:**
- on the *Start* screen: begins a game.
- during *play*: fires at the current aim position.
- on the *Game Over* screen: returns to the Start screen.
- on the *Reset* prompt: confirms wiping the high score.
- **Joystick button - hold 10 seconds** (Start or Game Over only): opens the

"Reset High Score?" prompt.

Visual / physical outputs

- **LED matrix:** the playfield - walls, the 2x2 target, and the aim dot.
- **TFT screen:** start screen, live score and hearts (lives) during play, and the

game-over / reset screens.

- **Red LED:** blinks while a target is not yet locked. **Green LED:** solid while

the aim is on the target.

- **Servos:** swing to match the aim, like a turret.

Normal flow: power on -> Start screen (shows the saved high score) -> click to play -> score by hitting targets, lose a life on each miss -> at 0 lives the Game Over screen shows the final and high scores -> click to return to Start.

Hardware Components Used

- Arduino Uno R3 (ATmega328P microcontroller)
- MAX7219-based 4-in-1 8x8 LED matrix module (32x8 playfield)
- ST7735 1.8" SPI color TFT LCD (128x160)
- Analog joystick module (X, Y, and push-button)
- 2x hobby servo motors (turret X and Y)
- 2x LEDs (red, green) with current-limiting resistors (220 ohm)
- Breadboard, jumper wires, and a separate 5V supply for the servos (common ground)

Software Libraries Used

No external/third-party libraries were used. Only standard AVR-libc / toolchain headers:

- **avr/io.h** - register and pin definitions for the ATmega328P.
- **avr/interrupt.h** - the ISR() macro and interrupt control, used for the Timer1

servo pulses and the Timer2 scheduler tick.

- **avr/eeprom.h** - `eeprom_read_word` / `eeprom_update_word` to persist the high

score.

- **util/delay.h** - short blocking delays used only in the TFT power-on sequence.
- **avr/pgmspace.h** - stores the font and heart bitmaps in flash (PROGMEM) to save

RAM.

All peripheral drivers (LED matrix, TFT, ADC/joystick) were written from scratch.

Wiring Diagram

<insert hand-drawn or tool-drawn wiring diagram here, plus a photo of the setup>

Pin map (Arduino Uno):

Pin	Connected to	Dir
A0 / A1	Joystick VRx / VRy	In
A2 / A3	Servo X / Servo Y signal	Out
D2	Joystick button (SW), internal pull-up	In
D4 / D5	Green LED / Red LED (via resistor)	Out
D7	TFT RST	Out
D8	TFT DC	Out
D9	TFT CS	Out
D10	MAX7219 CS	Out
D11	MAX7219 DIN + TFT SDA (shared MOSI)	Out
D13	MAX7219 CLK + TFT SCK (shared clock)	Out

Power: 5V and GND from the Uno feed the matrix, TFT, joystick, and LEDs; the two servos use a separate 5V supply with its ground tied to the common ground.

Task Diagram

Scheduler: a Timer2 compare interrupt sets a flag every 1 ms (the GCD). The main loop runs the task list when the flag is set; each task ticks at its own period. The two servos are generated independently by Timer1 in the background.

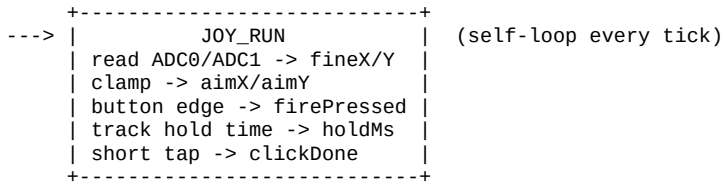
```
                        SHARED VARIABLES (globals)
gameState:uchar  aimX,aimY:uchar  targetX,targetY:uchar  score:uint
lives:uchar  highScore:uint  lockedOn:uchar  firePressed:uchar
holdMs:uint  clickDone:uchar  fineX,fineY:int  randomState:uint
(no queues are used)

INPUTS                                                    OUTPUTS
ADC0/ADC1 (A0/A1) --> [ T1: Joystick  20ms ] --> fineX,fineY,aimX,aimY,
button (D2) ------->                              firePressed, holdMs, clickDone

firePressed,holdMs,    --> [ T2: Game     20ms ] --> score, lives, highScore,
aimX,aimY,score,lives                                 lockedOn, targetX/Y,
                                                      gameState, EEPROM(highScore)

gameState,aimX/aimY,    --> [ T3: Matrix   30ms ] --> LED matrix (MAX7219)
targetX/Y

aimX,aimY -------------> [ T4: Servo    40ms ] --> OCR1A, OCR1B (servo angle)

gameState,score,lives,  --> [ T5: HUD/TFT  60ms ] --> TFT screen
highScore
gameState,lockedOn ----> [ T6: LEDs    150ms ] --> red LED (D5), green LED (D4)
```

SynchSM Diagrams

Notation: each box is a state; arrows are transitions with their conditions. "Period" is the task's tick period.

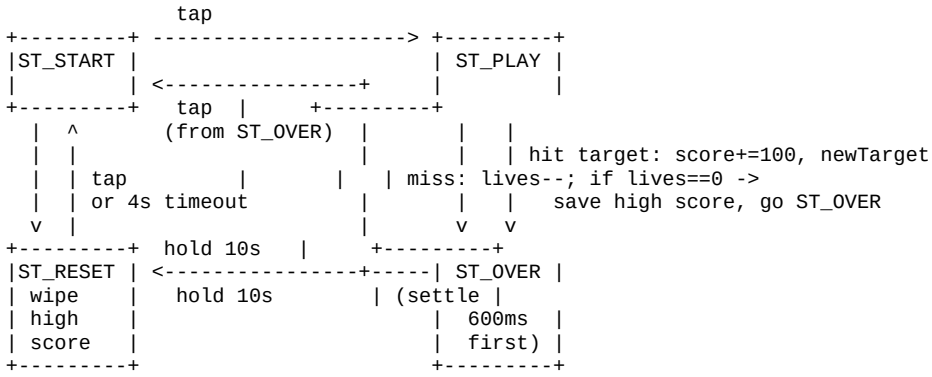
Task 1 - Joystick (period 20 ms)

Local variables: none (button state is kept in the shared variables)



Task 2 - Game (period 20 ms)

Local variables: `resetTimer:uint`, `overSettle:uint`



Transitions in words:

- ST_START: quick tap -> start a new game (ST_PLAY); 10-second hold -> ST_RESET.
- ST_PLAY: on fire, if locked -> +100 and respawn; if miss -> lose a life; at 0

lives, save the high score to EEPROM and go to ST_OVER.

- ST_OVER: ignore input for 600 ms (so the fatal shot is not re-read); then a quick

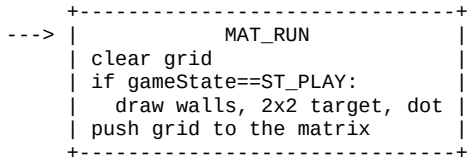
tap -> ST_START, a 10-second hold -> ST_RESET.

- ST_RESET: a tap -> set highScore=0, write EEPROM, go ST_START; no tap for 4 s

-> cancel to ST_START.

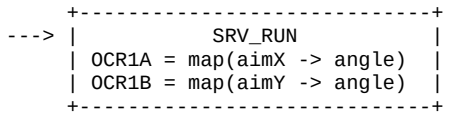
Task 3 - Matrix (period 30 ms)

Local variable: `grid[8][4]:uchar`



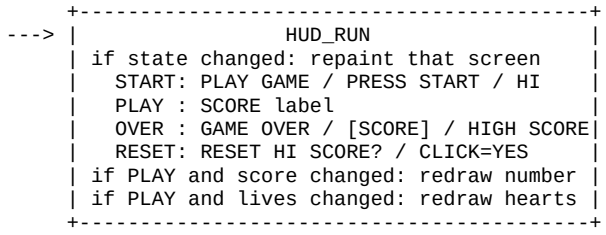
Task 4 - Servo (period 40 ms)

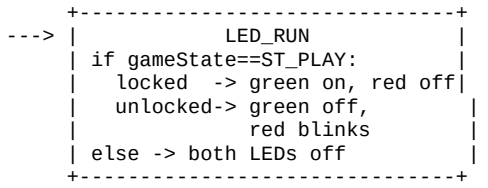
No local variables.



Task 5 - HUD / TFT (period 60 ms)

Local variables: `prevState:uchar`, `prevScore:uint`, `prevLives:uchar`



Task 6 - LEDs (period 150 ms)

Local variable: `blink:uchar`